

It's In The Air... ...Or Is It?

I WAS IN Boston, in a Mac store, buying myself a Macbook. At approximately the same time, not very far away, Steve Jobs pulled out the world's slimmest laptop from an envelope and revealed it to the world.

The reason I was out shopping for a new laptop was because I was tired of lugging my aging Lenovo around, and my shoulders were pleading for some respite. Apart from just looking cool, the smallest laptops are just extremely convenient.

While out shopping, I was quite taken by the Sony Vaio TZ series and the ASUS Eee. I remembered what Agent001 told me before I left: "There is only that much you can fit into this space, you know." Just a few days later, the guys at Apple seemed to disagree, and packed in so much more into so much less!

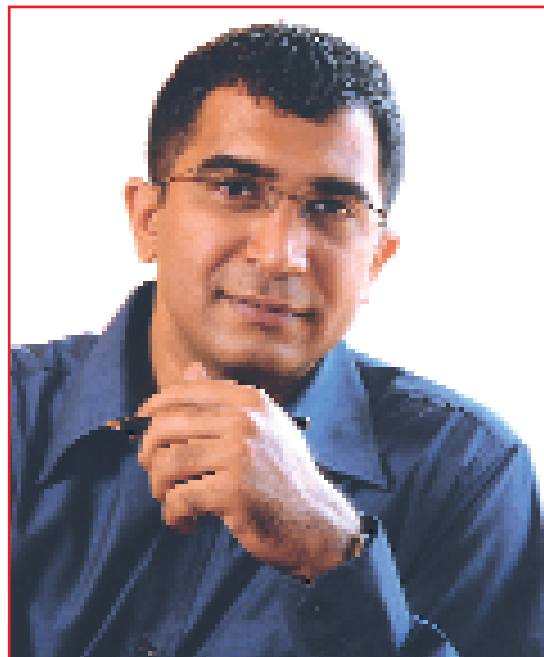
However, while most of the world ooh-ed and aah-ed over the Air's design elements, a select few shook their heads in disgust. A tech savvy Ryersons student said, "How could Apple have forgotten to add mobile broadband to it? I have no real reason to trade in my Macbook. It makes the whole Air thing pointless."

Other power users are miffed about the inbuilt battery. "I can't even pack an extra battery for long-haul flights back to India," says Anita Sharma, a student of Massachusetts Institute of Technology. The claimed five hour battery backup with WiFi turned on is something that remains to be seen.

Another enthusiast said, "Stuff like this is meant for the connected. There is a lack of functionality here. The product seems to be a prototype, what with no 3G functionalities built in."

Now, I am not the kind of user who goes by looks alone. I need functionality—Firewire, Ethernet, replaceable battery, etc. The choice was obvious for me: rather than spending USD 1,799 on a cool looking Air, I decided to get myself a normal Macbook.

With Steve Jobs himself admitting that the Air lacked features, not much is left to be said in this matter. However, I can't help but wonder what the



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future holds for the Air. Will the killer looks of the Air impress the masses and silence its critics, or will the lack of functionality be its undoing?

What I find curious is that despite knowing all they knew, and saying all they said, when I asked the dissenters whether they'd get the Air if I just gave them \$1,800, most said "Sure!"

